UNIT-6

REPORTS: PREWRITING

PREWRITING

- It is referred to as **the preliminary steps** to writing a report
- **Planning** stage is the most crucial one
- Spend as much time as possible in **collecting material, synchronize details, and ensuring that nothing has been left out**.
- If planning is done in detailed manner there are few chances of errors creeping in at the final stage.
- **Planning for a report is as important as the process of writing itself.**
- **Various steps involved in planning are as follows**:
- i) **Understanding the purpose and scope**
- **ii) Analysing the audience**
- **iii) Investigating the sources of information**
- **iv)Organizing material**
- **v)Making an outline**

Steps involved in planning

- **i) <u>Understanding the purpose and scope:</u>**
- **Purpose:** The objective of your study
- **Scope:** Extent of Coverage
- It is purpose of report that enables you to decide the **amount and method** of data to be collected, the **quality and quantity of the information** to be included in the report, and
- also the **methodology to be adopted in analyzing the situation and arriving at a solution.**
- **It is essential to understand the nature of the report**- whether it is informative or analytical.
- In most of the reports by government organizations, the **objectives(purpose)** are stated as ***<u>terms of reference</u>***.
- ***<u>These terms are specific instructions</u>*** *given to the* ***report writer*** *as to what* ***<u>objectives are to be achieved through the report</u>***.
- **Example:** to identify the causes behind the recent fire accident, to analyze existing fire fighting facilities etc.

Steps involved in planning

- **ii) <u>Analysing the audience:</u>**
- The audience for a technical report is intended or potential reader.
- you adapt your writing to meet the needs , interests, and background of the of the readers who will be reading your report.
- **Identifying the type of audience**: **<u>Experts , Executives or Non-specialists</u>**.
- **Experts**: are the people who know the theory and the product inside and out. They designed it , they tested it, they know everything about it. They operate in academic settings, or in research and development areas of government and business worlds.
- **Executives:** are the people who make business, economic, administrative , legal, governmental, and political decisions on the matter that the experts and technicians work with**.**
- **Non-Specialists:** who have the least technical knowledge of all. Their interest may be as practical as technicians. They want to use the new product to accomplish their tasks…
- **Background**- knowledge, Experience, and Training- you expect in your readers
- **Needs and Interests.**
- **Demographic characteristics:** age group, type of residence, area of residence, political preference etc…
- more than one audience., variability in an audience

Steps involved in planning

- **iii) <u>Investigating the sources of information</u>**
- To achieve the objectives of your report, you require facts and ideas.
- You may find them in company records , reports, bulletins, pamphlets, and periodicals.
- It may **be based on your observation or personal interview** with people.
- **<u>The important means of collecting data</u>** for your report are:
- -**i)searching library materia**l , internal records, or databases
- -ii)**personal observation**
- -iii)**conducting personal interviews** or telephone interviews
- -iv)**preparing and circulating questionnaires**
- **i) Library search-** In reports on subjects of a general nature, library research may be found useful
- This includes reference to standard reference books, and past and current issues of newspapers, trade publications, research journal, and magazines.

Steps involved in planning

- **Library search:**
- Eg- report on the analysis of online marketing strategies
- Now- a-days , many online **library catalogues** may assist you in identifying the books, journals, periodicals etc.
- **Ii)internal Records**: relevant information is already contained in the old files of the organization.

iii) Database Search: choose appropriate database, use multiple search engines, use keywords and phrases, use appropriate order, …

iv)Personal Observations : observation is **seeing with purpose. it** is a method of data collection **for securing first hand information**. It forms mental impression of what is **observed. Two kinds of observation :**

a) Controlled observation b)uncontrolled observation

Controlled- scientific research – scientists carry on experiments and record findings

Uncontrolled observations: you view the things as they are

Steps involved in planning

- **V) Interviews**: An interview is an interaction or conversation with a purpose.
- It is an effective method of collecting primary information directly from an expert
- **Interviews conducted with the purpose of colleting data are called data collection interview**
- A successful interview requires careful planning and organization to get the information you need
- They can be personal or telephonic
- **Vi) Preparing questions**: preparing questions you feel confident and will save respondent's time
- **Types of questions:**
- **open ended** to invite interviewee's opinion
- **Direct open ended**- gives interviewee some freedom but to gives you more control
- **Close ended-** yes/no , short answers
- **Restatement questions-** mirror a respondents previous answer and invite to expand the answer.
- -**Guidelines to pose the questions during interview for writing report:**

Steps involved in planning

- **Telephone interview**: useful for opinion polls, limited number of questions are asked., more expensive..
- Quickest survey technique,
- Refusal rate is low
- Cost per interview is low
- **Questionnaires:** one of the best methods to ask primary information with relevant experience and opinion known as survey.
- **Purpose of survey**
- **Preparing questions**
- **Sampling: it is enough if you choose a part of the group for sampling**
- **Type of sampling:**
- **i)Random:** every fifth or tenth name
- **ii) stratified :**if you divide employees into categories ad select names from each group
- **iii) proportionate:** control the selection in such a way that characteristics of the whole group are represented proportionately

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Steps involved in planning

- **Iv) Organizing Material**
- **Depending upon the topic, purpose, and audience , you can organize the material / data collected:**
- **a)The order of occurrence**
- **b)Order of importance**
- **c)Combination of orders**
- **A)Order of occurrence:** also known as **chronological order**, presented as per sequence that depends on time that is more or less of uniform value
- Eg-history of transaction, procedure of manufacturing or installing equipment
- **b)Order of importance:** if the data collected is not of uniform value, you may have to arrange it **in ascending or descending** order of importance.
- Eg-Feasibility reports, feedback report on conference recently attended

Steps involved in planning

- **C) combination of orders:**
- Partially useful in double assignments.
- A combination of order of occurrence and order of importance.
- Eg- report on the appraisal of a situation and the recommended changes
- Report on a problem and suggested solutions.

Steps in Prewriting

- **V)Making an outline:**
- It is important to develop an outline of report
- **<u>An outline is mechanical framework into which you can fit in bits and pieces of information you have collected for your report.</u>**
- It serves as **<u>signpost</u>** to show you the right direction in which you need to proceed for writing your report.
- It requires time, hence spend time on a systematic outline as it helps save time.
- **To prepare an effective outline follow the tips:**
- Use words and phrases
- Use Nouns

Steps in Prewriting

- **To prepare an effective outline follow the tips:**
- Use parallel grammatical constructions
- Follow principal of coordination and subordination
- Use decimal numbering system

Outline--example

- **Education System in India**:
- 1. Introduction
- 2.Status before independence
- 3. Present Status
- 3.1Primay
- 3.2.Secondary
- 3.3.Higher Secondary
- 3.4. college Education, University Education
- 3.5 Status of Women in education
- 3.5.1-pre-independence
- 3.5.2-post independence
- 4. Improvements or Modification in system
- 5.Importance of Employability skills
- 6.Conclusion